

Social Tech Intelligence Report 2026

How content consumption shifts across South Africa, North Africa, and global markets — and what it means for brand strategy.

Executive summary

Recent research indicates that digital media consumption is increasingly mobile-first, video-heavy, and driven by algorithmic discovery. Deloitte’s Digital Media Trends (2025) highlights that social content is seen as more relevant than traditional TV for many younger audiences. PwC’s Africa Entertainment & Media Outlook (2025–2029) positions South Africa as Africa’s largest E&M; market and shows rapid shifts toward digital advertising and video. PwC’s Global Entertainment & Media Outlook (2025–2029) projects industry revenue reaching US\$3.5 trillion by 2029, with advertising as a key growth engine.

Key numbers (latest published figures)

Region / Country (report year)	Internet users	Social media users (identities)	Notable signal
South Africa (Jan 2025)	50.8M (78.9%)	26.7M (41.5%)	Mobile video dominates; social is core to discovery
Egypt (Jan 2025)	96.3M (81.9%)	50.7M (43.1%)	Large scale; strong video + messaging usage
Morocco (Jan 2025)	35.3M (92.2%)	21.3M (55.5%)	High penetration; strong social adoption
Global (2029 forecast)	—	—	E&M; revenue to US\$3.5T; advertising leads growth

1) South Africa: what audiences consume most

Dominant consumption: short-form video; entrepreneurship and side-hustle content; financial literacy; politics/culture; local creator storytelling.

Why it matters: high mobile reach and video-led data usage means brands should design mobile-first funnels and video-led creative.

2) North Africa (examples: Egypt, Morocco)

Dominant consumption: long-form educational video; culturally aligned content; career and academic advancement; tech tutorials; regional news.

Why it matters: stronger tolerance for structured, information-heavy formats supports educational positioning and enterprise enablement.

3) Global markets (US/UK/EU): what performs

Dominant consumption: AI/emerging tech; productivity systems; personal branding; investing; niche communities.

Why it matters: buyers are analytics-driven; ROI proof and case studies outperform generic brand awareness messaging.

Strategy: B2B vs B2C positioning

B2C wins with relatability, frequency, and short-form video that simplifies value into lifestyle narratives.

B2B wins with authority: data-backed insights, case studies, proof-of-work, and clear performance outcomes.

Enterprise & gamification

Enterprise teams increasingly use digital engagement patterns (including gamification) for onboarding, system adoption, training, and compliance. For brands and agencies, this unlocks a new lane: social technology as behavioural infrastructure, not only marketing.

Sources (selected)

- Deloitte Insights — Digital Media Trends 2025 (published Mar 2025).
- PwC South Africa — Africa Entertainment & Media Outlook 2025–2029 (published Oct 2025).
- PwC — Global Entertainment & Media Outlook 2025–2029 (published Jul 2025).
- DataReportal — Digital 2025 reports for South Africa, Egypt, Morocco (published Mar 2025).

Note: DataReportal reports present 'user identities' for social platforms, which may not equal unique individuals. Forecasts are subject to revisions as datasets update.